

TOPSY TURVY		The ups and downs on the TRP scale in the past four months	
A P R I L	6-12 APRIL		Colors becomes No. 1, dislodging Star Plus after nine years, with shows like <i>Balika Vadhu</i> and <i>Uttaran</i> .
	13-19 APRIL		<i>Bandini</i> and <i>Jyoti</i> , shows set in small town India, help NDTV Imagine to race past Sony at number four.
	20-26 APRIL		Star Plus fights back with a strong film line-up including <i>Welcome</i> , <i>Main Hoon Na</i> and <i>Bhagam Bhag</i> to regain the No. 1 slot, though not for long.
M A Y	18-24 MAY		Colors regains the top position yet again, riding on the curiosity generated around Krishna growing up on <i>Jai Shri Krishna</i> .
	25-31 MAY		Star Plus is pushed to third position, while Zee TV with the <i>Dance India Dance</i> finale races to No. 2. The show about ordinary people with extraordinary dancing prowess gets the audience hooked.
	1-7 JUNE		Colors continues its third week No. 1 run. Star Plus claws back to No. 2 as the audience that watched <i>Dance India Dance</i> on Zee TV returns.
J U N E	8-14 JUNE		The yo-yo continues. Star Plus becomes No. 1 with the telecast of Star Parivaar awards after Colors's three week reign.
	22-28 JUNE		Zee TV displaces Colors with a packed prime time which has shows like <i>Agle Janam...</i> and <i>Pavitra Rishta</i> .
	29-5 JUNE/JULY		Colors becomes No. 1 again. NDTV Imagine topples Sony for the No. 4 position with <i>Rakhi ka Swayamvar</i> opening at a TRP of 4.1.
J U L Y	6-12 JULY		Star Plus claws its way to the top after weeks of uncertainty. But it remains ahead of Colors only by a small margin thanks to <i>Sacch ka Saamna</i> .
	13-19 JULY		Colors is on top again, thanks to its reality show <i>India's Got Talent</i> . NDTV Imagine is pushed to No. 5 and Sony with <i>Iss Jungle se Mujhe Bachao</i> that opens with a TRP of 3.13, regains No. 4.

Bachao kicking off with a TRP of 3.13, the veil has been lifted from TV's sacrificing bahu and betis. The eyeballs and TRPs now belong to outrageous utterances, bedroom secrets, daredevil stunts, and letting slimy somethings crawl all over your face. The seeds were sown a long-time ago when Tulsi on *Kyunki...* killed her own son. Anurag Basu on *Kasautii Zindagii Kay* entered into holy matrimony multiple times and Saloni on *Saat Phere* uncovered the truth about her husband's previous marriage. "It seems strange that rape and polygamy are accepted in fiction but as soon as we're talking about real people, it becomes shocking," says Anita Kaul Basu, MD, Big Synergy, which produces *Sacch ka Saamna*. Sociologist Sanjay Srivastava says it has to do with ours being a liminal culture, caught between the rise of individualism and the existence of the larger family context. Some uncomfortable things are best left unsaid.

Sawant is a typical case of this in betweenness, a modern materialistic woman but also one who believes, indeed yearns for, the traditional trappings of marriage. Her struggle from item girl disgrace to aspirational bahu respectability is

NAAANA IS DES LAADO

Set in Haryana, in a village where no one wants over-the-top statements berating her pregnant

